

Which App?

When you sit down to use AI, your first decision is which app to open. Three dominate: ChatGPT from OpenAI, Claude from Anthropic, and Gemini from Google. All three can chat, write, code, and answer questions. So why does it matter which one you pick?



DIFFERENT PHILOSOPHIES

Think about it like this. In-N-Out and McDonald's both sell cheeseburgers, built from roughly the same ingredients. They're still completely different experiences, because each company has a different idea of what a burger place should be. One does a tiny menu with everything made fresh. The other is engineered for speed, scale, and being exactly the same in every city on Earth.

The big three LLM apps work the same way. They're all Generative AI, trained on much of the same internet. But each company trains its model with different priorities and rules.

Those training choices shape everything: how the app feels to use, what it's good at, and what it gets wrong. Underneath, each one is built around a different core philosophy.

The big three, side by side

ChatGPT

The Anything Box

One app aimed at everyone. ChatGPT kicked off the AI era in 2022 and made it mainstream. It's the default most people start with, and often what they mean when they say 'AI.'

BEST FOR

- ✓ Brainstorming
- ✓ Quick drafts of anything
- ✓ Everyday varied tasks
- ✓ Voice and image features

OpenAI asks: How do we put the most capable AI in everyone's hands?

Claude

The Thinking Partner

Trained around an explicit set of principles about what to do and what not to do. Built to think problems through with you, not just hand you the fastest answer.

BEST FOR

- ✓ Coding
- ✓ Analysis and research
- ✓ Long-form writing
- ✓ Tasks where accuracy matters most

Anthropic asks: How do we build powerful AI we can actually trust?

Gemini

Built Into Everything

Lives inside the tools you already use: Search, Gmail, Docs, YouTube, Android. Its edge is context. It can see the doc you're writing or the video you're watching, and bring what Google knows to where you already are.

BEST FOR

- ✓ Current events
- ✓ Research requiring live data
- ✓ Summarizing YouTube videos
- ✓ Anything in the Google ecosystem

Google asks: How do we put AI inside everything you already use?

WHICH APP IS BEST?

The best app is the one that fits the job. Most people just use whatever they opened last.

Each philosophy turns into a different kind of strength. ChatGPT is built for breadth. Claude is built for depth. Gemini is built for context.

WHAT SHOULD YOU USE?

Honest answer: for most of what you'll do, any of the three works. Don't agonize over the choice.

Pick one as your home base and learn it well: its settings, its features, its quirks. Knowing one app deeply beats dabbling in all three. Then borrow another when the job clearly fits its strength, and check back on the others every few months. These apps change fast, and the gap you remember may be gone.

One move to consider: when an answer really matters, ask the same question in a second app. Two differently trained models agreeing is real evidence. Two models disagreeing tells you exactly where to dig.



The skills transfer. The app is just where you practice them. Everything this course teaches, prompting, checking, staying in charge, works the same in all three. Which app you pick matters far less than how well you learn to drive it.

TRY IT

Match the right app to the job. Four scenarios. Pick which one fits each best.